

BMW 740Li

The peak of BMW's luxury offerings

Despite the shortcomings, the BMW 7 Series never fails to put a smile on your face.

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THE TECHNOLOGY INSIDE

Customisability and fragrances

The BMW 740Li is furnished with carefully picked veneer and plush leather. You get to even choose the thread on the smooth leather stitching. You also get a fragrance dispenser stowed inside the dash, and BMW gives you the option to select two distinct fragrances as per your wish from their bespoke collection. You can even control the intensity of the perfume in three different stages.

The infotainment system

The 9.2-inch infotainment display is powered by the familiar BMW ConnectedDrive infotainment firmware. The display is touch-enabled, but still retains the wonderful iDrive controller.

The options here remain similar to what you'd find it in the likes of the BMW 5 series – a 3D satellite-linked navigation unit with live traffic data, point-of-interest, landmarks and multiple map views. Other options include driving dynamics, standard phone settings, application setup on the ConnectedDrive display, and input interfaces include Bluetooth, USB, a CD/DVD drive, SD card and aux-in.

Gesture control

The BMW 740Li recognises a range of gestures. For instance, you twirl your finger clockwise (or anticlockwise) in

front of the central column to turn up (or down) the volume, point two fingers at it to switch to the next track.

Touch and iDrive inputs

You get a 10-way iDrive controller with a handwriting recognition pad at the



This is the best that BMW has on offer

centre, seven physical keys to select options in the infotainment software, and the seamless ease of usage is as good as always. The buttons and the selector are girded by metal.

The touch performance of the BMW 7's infotainment display is quite decent, although you will mostly be operating it via the iDrive controller. The biggest reason for this is the way it is placed – high on the dash, and away from the driver's instinctive reach.

Audio setup

While the international trim comes with Bowers & Wilkins speakers, the India-spec variant comes with a Harman/Kardon audio system. You get decent customisability, with an equaliser, standard balance/fader, and two modes that allow you to pinpoint the sound across the entire car cabin or to the driver. The sound itself is somewhat underwhelming, that you would expect from an upmarket in-car audio setup.

The mids sound flat, and although highs are smooth and prominent, the bass lacks depth in comparison to the other audio setups found in luxury cars. Overall soundstaging, meanwhile, is quite decent, and it fares quite well in directional audio distribution.



The iDrive controller remains among the best input systems in the market

Automatic parking

The automatic parking interface is a little difficult to fathom, since even detection of the parking space is done automatically. All that you can do is put the gear in reverse, and wait for the car to detect if enough parking space is available for it. The highly automated interface will see very few people actually using the system too often, but the entire process is well guided with screen prompts that make you only take control of the gear shifts. A simpler interface here would have helped the autonomous operations.

Smart key

The smart key hosts a small, multi-colour resistive touchscreen interface, and the options presented through it include central locking for doors and windows, remote switching of lights, a mileage indicator that shows the car's fuel range till empty, a pre-timer for the